

SEWV Support Knowledge Base — 02: Admin Task Procedures

These are the exact backend steps a human admin needs to run after certain email replies. When I draft a reply that requires backend action, I'll append a clearly labeled "Admin follow-up" checklist referencing the relevant procedure below.

Tools referenced: **Teachable** (course platform/LMS), **Kit** (email marketing — tags + sequences + automations), **Stripe** (primary payment processor), **PayPal** (secondary payment processor).

Procedure A — Cancel a Monthly Membership

1. Teachable → Users → search student's email → open profile → Purchases tab.
2. Confirm "Active Subscriptions" is showing at top (proof it's currently active).
3. Click the three-dot menu → Delete Subscription → confirm **Yes**.
4. Kit → Subscribers → search email → open profile → Tags.
5. Delete the relevant membership tag(s). Most common: **"FFC 3.0"** and **"FFC Purchased"** (Monthly Membership). Second most common: **"FFC: Yearly"** (Yearly Membership). Delete whichever matches the product they're canceling.
6. Add the cancel tag (e.g. "FFC cancel").
7. Refresh — the system should auto-send the student a cancellation confirmation email shortly after.

Procedure B — ~~Monthly failed payment / non-member cleanup in Kit~~ (DISCONTINUED — testing Zapier automation instead)

This procedure is on hold. A Zapier automation is being tested to handle this instead (removing the membership tag automatically after a 3rd failed payment attempt). Testing period: **45 days**. If the automation doesn't work reliably, this manual procedure may come back — keeping the steps below for reference in case that happens.

Old manual procedure (for reference only, not currently used) This removes access for people whose 3rd recurring-payment attempt failed (Teachable retries a failed charge up to 3x before giving up, but doesn't automatically strip their Kit tag).

1. Teachable → Courses → the Monthly Membership product → Students → confirm you're viewing everyone with the current membership tag (~hundreds of people).
2. Click **Export CSV** (arrives by email in a couple minutes).
3. Download the CSV.

4. Kit → Tags → Create a new tag named for this date (e.g. "February FFC").
5. Kit → Grow Subscribers → Add Subscribers → Import a CSV → drag in the file.
6. Map **Full Name** → **First Name** and **Email** → **Email**. Apply the new dated tag at the top (not the per-row "tags" column). Click Import.
7. Kit → Segments → Create Segment, name it for the date (e.g. "February 23 FFC").
8. Condition: "Subscribed to **all** of" → the active membership tag (e.g. "FFC 3.0" or "FFC Purchased"). Then **Add Filter Group** → "match **none** of" → the new dated tag you just imported.
9. This segment = everyone who still holds the membership tag but did **not** appear in this month's successful-payment export — i.e., failed payments. Remove the membership tag from everyone in this segment so they stop receiving paid content.

Procedure C — ~~First-of-the-month module unlock~~ (DISCONTINUED)

This procedure is no longer used. SEWV switched away from the monthly-unlock system — all modules are now available to every Monthly Membership, Yearly, and Lifetime student automatically, and new modules get added to everyone's account the moment they're launched (this happens **3 times a year**). There's no Kit automation step to edit anymore. If a student can't find the current module, just send them the direct link (see the 2026 Study Plan doc: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1RQmK_z48Y83lfJxSoP_GxJgfqi5nmmh/view?usp=sharing) or tell them to search for it by name after logging in — see playbook entry #14.

Procedure D — Misspelled email address, during Teachable business hours (M–F, ~8/9am–5pm)

1. First, check what email address they actually **sent the email from** — that's often the correct/real address, distinct from whatever got typed (correctly or not) into the checkout form. Then search for that address (or a partial guess based on it — part of their name, or part of the email itself), starting with **Teachable** — usually that's enough. Teachable's search will often surface a close match even from a partial/misspelled fragment — e.g. if their real email is "vanessajoyous@gmail.com" and they say they never got course emails, typing just "vanessa" into Teachable's search will likely find the account even if the full address on file is misspelled. Only if Teachable doesn't turn it up, check **Kit** next; only if that also comes up empty, check **Stripe** as a last resort.
2. Teachable → student profile → Information tab → correct the email spelling → Save. (This does **not** auto-send a confirmation email.)
3. Email Teachable Support: "A student signed up with an incorrect email address. I've corrected it and saved the change — could you manually resend their confirmation email?"

Procedure E — Misspelled email address, after hours / self-service

Give the student these instructions once the correction is saved (Procedure D step 2, minus the Teachable Support email):

1. Visit the course site — https://speak-english-with-vanessa.teachable.com/sign_in — and click "Forgot password." (This link will likely also be in the Phrase Express file once we have it — using it here as a fallback in case it isn't.)
2. Enter their (now-corrected) email address.
3. They'll receive a password-reset email → set a new password → log in.
4. A red banner should appear: "Please confirm your email to fully activate your account" with a "Resend email" link — have them click it.

Procedure F — Cleaning up a duplicate/bounced Kit entry from a misspelling

1. Search Kit for the incorrect spelling of the email.
2. If it shows as bounced/never-delivered and has no legitimate tags, delete that subscriber entry.
3. On the correct (primary) entry, re-apply whatever tag(s) they should have (e.g. "worksheet library," membership tag, etc.). Note: Teachable accounts **cannot be merged**. If someone has ended up with two real, paid Teachable accounts under two spellings, the options are: refund one and have them use only the other, or accept they'll have two accounts going forward.

Procedure G — Unbounce a subscriber in Kit

1. Confirm the bounce: subscriber's dot/status shows orange "Bounce" in Kit.
2. Take a screenshot for your own reference/for the student if helpful.
3. Contact Kit support (chat: "I need help using Kit" → Subscribers) with the subscriber's email: "This subscriber has been bounced from my email list — can you please un-bounce them?"
4. Separately, email Teachable Support asking them to resend the confirmation email once un-bounced.
5. Consider manually enrolling the student in the meantime if the bounce clearly wasn't their fault (e.g. iCloud/Yahoo/Hotmail delivery issues).

Procedure H — Troubleshoot general payment/access confusion (e.g. "I unsubscribed but got charged")

1. Teachable → confirm the charge date/amount on their account.
2. Kit → check their unsubscribe date and whether the paid-membership tag is still present.
3. Common root cause: they unsubscribed from the **newsletter**, which is not the same as canceling the **paid membership** — the membership tag/subscription was still active and got charged.
4. If so: run Procedure A (cancel) and refund the specific erroneous charge in Teachable (if within 30 days) or Stripe/PayPal directly (if older — see Procedures I/J).

Procedure I — Handle a Stripe payment dispute/chargeback notice

We no longer contest disputes. Submitting evidence is a lot of work and the bank almost always sides with the cardholder anyway, so the cost isn't worth it.

1. Delete/ignore the dispute notification — no evidence submission needed.
2. **Only if the dispute is about the Monthly Membership:** Teachable → confirm the student's subscription is actually canceled. If it's still showing active, delete it (Procedure A) so they don't keep getting charged/disputing. *(Older approach, no longer used: gathering recurring-charge consent screenshots, opened/clicked email evidence, and submitting via Stripe's dispute evidence flow. Keeping this note in case policy changes back.)*

Procedure J — Refund via PayPal (purchase 30+ days old, or paid via PayPal instead of Stripe)

Used when Teachable's built-in 30-day refund button is no longer available, or the payment icon in Teachable shows "P" (PayPal) rather than a card.

1. PayPal → Activity → All Transactions → search by customer name (widen the date range if the purchase might be 60+ days old).
2. Open the correct payment.
3. Click Refund → enter the amount (full or partial per what's owed) → Issue Refund.
4. PayPal auto-emails the customer a refund confirmation — no need to screenshot or manually notify them.
5. Still complete the Teachable side: delete their subscription/enrollment, and confirm Kit tags reflect cancellation.

Procedure K — Special-case refunds outside the normal 30-day window

Default policy: **approve it**, especially for hardship situations — proactive refunds are cheaper than fighting a dispute later.

1. Teachable → delete the subscription/enrollment.
2. Stripe → refund the specific payment(s) requested (e.g. "last 3 months" — refund those specific line items, not necessarily the very first \$5 trial payment unless asked). Leave an internal note in Stripe stating which months were refunded.
3. Kit → confirm the cancel tag is applied; unsubscribe from sales emails only if it seems appropriate/kind, not automatically.
4. **Escalate to Vanessa or Ailsa first** if: the purchase is 6–12+ months old, the student has consumed a large amount of course material, and there's no clear/sympathetic reason given — this may be a refund-abuse pattern worth a second opinion.

Procedure L — Grant full/early access to a challenge

1. Teachable → student profile → Enrollments tab.
2. Find the specific challenge enrollment → three-dot menu → **Grant Full Access** → confirm.
3. Student will now see all lessons unlocked immediately instead of one/day. **Evergreen, self-paced courses** (30 Day Listening Challenge packs, etc.): no restriction — always fine to grant full access. **Live, date-bound courses/promos** (e.g. a cohort-based Speaking Challenge with a shared start date): fine to grant full access **once the official start date has passed** — just don't do it before the course has actually started.

Procedure M — ~~Manually enroll a student in this month's module~~ (DISCONTINUED — no manual enrollment needed)

This procedure is no longer used. All modules are automatically available to every Monthly Membership student — there's nothing to manually enroll. If a student can't find the current module: check the **2026 Study Plan doc** (https://drive.google.com/file/d/1RQmK_z48Y83lfJxSoP_GxJgfgzi5nmmh/view?usp=sharing) for the current module name and its direct link, and send that link to the student (or tell them to log in and search for the module by name).

Procedure N — Create a personalized one-time coupon code

One standing exception, no approval needed: the Lifetime loyalty discount — \$650 off for \$200+ total historical FFC spend, or \$550 off for under \$200 — see playbook entry #15 for the exact rule. **For anything else, always confirm with Vanessa or Ailsa before offering a custom discount** — that remains judgment-call territory.

1. Once approved (or confirmed as the standing Lifetime loyalty-discount case): Teachable → Courses → select the specific product → Coupons → Create Coupon.
2. Set the discount amount/percentage. **On "single-use":** this depends on what's being discounted, not a blanket default —
 - **One-time purchase** (e.g. Lifetime): mark it single-use — the coupon only needs to apply once.
 - **Yearly subscription:** the discount should **always** apply to every renewal, not just the first year — so don't mark it single-use for Yearly, full stop. In Teachable's coupon settings, there's an option like "applies to first payment only" vs. "applies to all payments" — make sure **"applies to all payments"** is selected.
 - **Payment plan** (e.g. Lifetime's 4-month plan): make sure the coupon applies across **all** of the installments, not just the first payment.
 - This mostly comes up with **Yearly** subscriptions — that's the most common case where getting this wrong (defaulting to single-use) would under-deliver the discount you promised the student.

3. Set an expiration date matching whatever was offered.
4. Send the resulting checkout link (with coupon auto-applied, ideally — see Procedure Q for how to embed the coupon directly in the link) to the student.

Procedure O — Unsubscribe / Resubscribe in Kit

Unsubscribe: Click "Unsubscribe from all" on the subscriber's Kit profile (or use the unsubscribe link at the bottom of any email already sent to them). **Resubscribe:** On their Kit profile, click "Resubscribe" → confirm "Yes." Only do this with the person's explicit consent/request. If someone has been unsubscribed 6+ months, the cleanest path is often to have them opt back in via a fresh lead-magnet/PDF signup form (auto re-adds them to the newsletter). If that's not workable, Kit support can manually resubscribe someone — keep written consent on file (their email request) before asking.

Procedure P — "Safe Unsubscribe" bounce-back handling

These are auto-generated notices (often in French) that someone's own unsubscribe click failed to process.

1. Open the email; it contains the person's address and a direct link.
2. Click the link — it routes straight to unsubscribing them in Kit.
3. If the link doesn't work, manually search their email in Kit → Grow → Subscribers, and unsubscribe them from there directly.

Procedure Q — Add a coupon code directly to a checkout link

Whenever offering a student a coupon, it's best to embed it directly in the link so they don't have to type it in themselves (and risk mistyping it or missing the field entirely).

1. Copy the product's pricing plan link (the checkout URL, not the sales page).
2. Open it in an **incognito/private browser tab** (so you're not logged into your own admin/test account).
3. Add `&couponcode=COUPONCODENAMEHERE` to the end of the URL (replace with the actual coupon code) — but **don't press Enter yet**.
4. Copy the full URL as-is (with the coupon code appended) — this is what goes in the email to the student.
5. **Then** press Enter in the incognito tab to load the page and confirm it actually shows the discounted price correctly before sending it along.

Note on trust in automation: SEWV uses Zapier to sync Teachable ⇌ Kit tags automatically (e.g. a Teachable cancellation should auto-remove the Kit tag). In practice, the team does **not** rely on this alone — always double-check/manually confirm the Kit side after any Teachable

change (cancel, refund, enroll), since the automation is known to occasionally miss people ("fall through the cracks").